

54 PER CENT

of respondents say GST has simplified compliance for businesses, while 23 per cent think otherwise

46 PER CENT

of those polled say the government has not provided enough support to small businesses and startups, while 42 per cent disagree

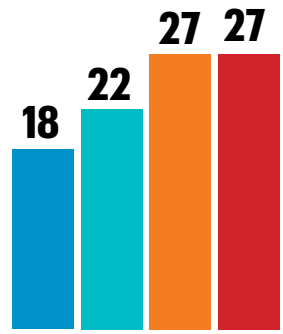
salaries and household incomes will stagnate over the next six months, up slightly from 33.8 per cent previously, while 30.3 per cent expect conditions to deteriorate.

One source of temperance—despite stagnant wages and job security continuing to squeeze household budgets—is headline inflation tapering down to 1.55 per cent in July, helped by easing food prices. Yet that headline figure, a year-on-year measure, signals only a slower pace of price rises, not a fall in costs. Consequently, 60.6 per cent of respondents say managing everyday expenses remains a struggle, although this is 3.7 percentage points lower than those who said so in the previous MOTN. Meanwhile, 30.7 per cent report that their expenses have increased but remain manageable, a rise from 27.5 per cent in February.

Last year, the Centre rolled out a slew of initiatives, including the Prime Minister's Internship Scheme, to tackle unemployment and bridge the gap between education and employment. It allocated Rs 10,831 crore for FY26 to provide internships to 10 million youth, especially those Not in Education, Employment or Training (NEET). Yet progress has been sluggish, hampered by regulatory hurdles and limited awareness. Joblessness remains a pressing worry for India's youth: 50.7 per cent of respondents rate the jobs situation as 'very serious', a slight improvement from 55 per cent in February, while 20.8 per cent consider it 'somewhat serious', down marginally from 21.2 per cent. Most (48.5 per cent) prefer government jobs, compared to private-sector roles (8.5 per cent), though 34.7 per cent choose to run their own businesses.

The economy continues to be a persistent headache for the government, as in past years. This time, however, the challenges seem manifold and, in some cases, beyond the Centre's control. Steering the country through these choppy seas will demand economic dexterity from the Modi government. ■

Q. How easy or difficult is it to start and run a business in India?



A majority find it difficult to start and run a business in India

All figures in % and rounded off
DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say